

Deploying a Zoho Creator Application from Development to Production Environment

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Aim

To demonstrate the development-to-production deployment workflow of a Zoho Creator application using environments.

Introduction

Zoho Creator provides an Environments feature, described on its page as a multi-stage deployment space to test and publish an application without affecting the production. An application passes through three environments:

Environment	Purpose
Development	The environment in which the application is built, configured and changed. Changes made here do not reach end users.
Stage	An intermediate testing environment in which the application is deployed and tested before release.
Production	The live environment in which the tested application is published and used by end users.

Separating the environments allows new changes to be verified in Stage before they are released, so that the live application in Production is not disturbed by incomplete or untested work.

Application Used

Vehicle Service Request (VSR) – an application to manage vehicle service requests, track status and service history.

Procedure

The deployment follows the flow shown below:

Development Environment → Stage Environment → Production Environment

Note: Figures 1 and 2 are screens of the Zoho Creator account. Figures 3, 4 and 5 are illustrative views of the Development, Stage and Production stages of the Vehicle Service Request application, used to demonstrate the deployment workflow; the statuses and dates in these figures are as displayed in the illustrations.

1. Sign in to Zoho Creator. The home page shows the Vehicle Service Request application. The left panel is divided into the groups DEVELOP, DEPLOY and MANAGE; the DEPLOY group contains the Environments, Mobile and Portal options. The Environments option is used for deploying applications across environments.

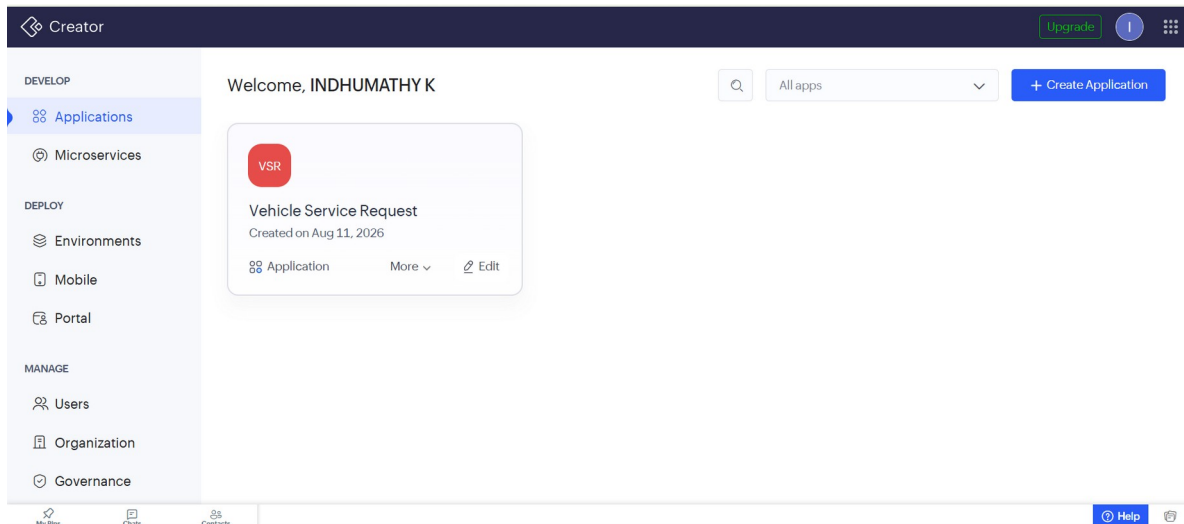


Figure 1: Zoho Creator Home – Vehicle Service Request Application and the DEPLOY → Environments Option

2. Select Environments under DEPLOY. The Environments page opens with the description “Multi-stage deployment space to test and publish your application without affecting the production”, and with the Version History, Manage and Publish options at the top. The page shows the Stage and Production environments as separate columns. At this point, the message “There are no applications added to the environment” is shown in the left panel, and the Stage and Production columns display “No applications in Stage yet” and “No applications in Production yet”. An Add Application button is provided to add an application to the environment.

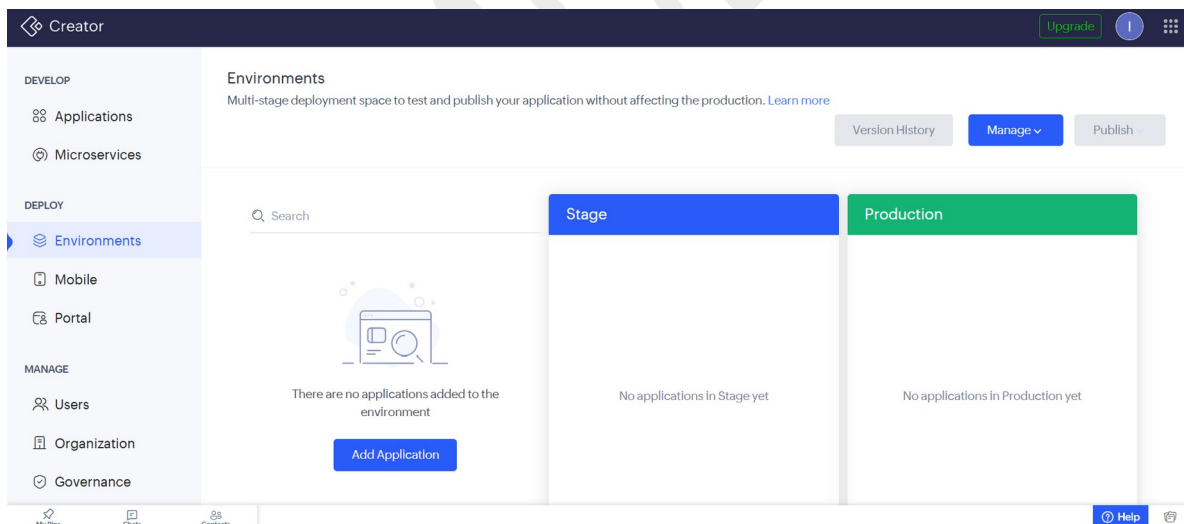


Figure 2: Environments Page – Stage and Production Environments

3. Development environment: the Vehicle Service Request (VSR) application is shown in the Development environment, where application changes are first developed and tested. The view displays the application name and description, the environment tabs Development, Stage and Production (Development selected), the Environment as Development and the status Ready for Deployment. The details Last updated: Sep 29, 2025 and Owned by: You are also shown, together with the Version History, Manage and Publish options.

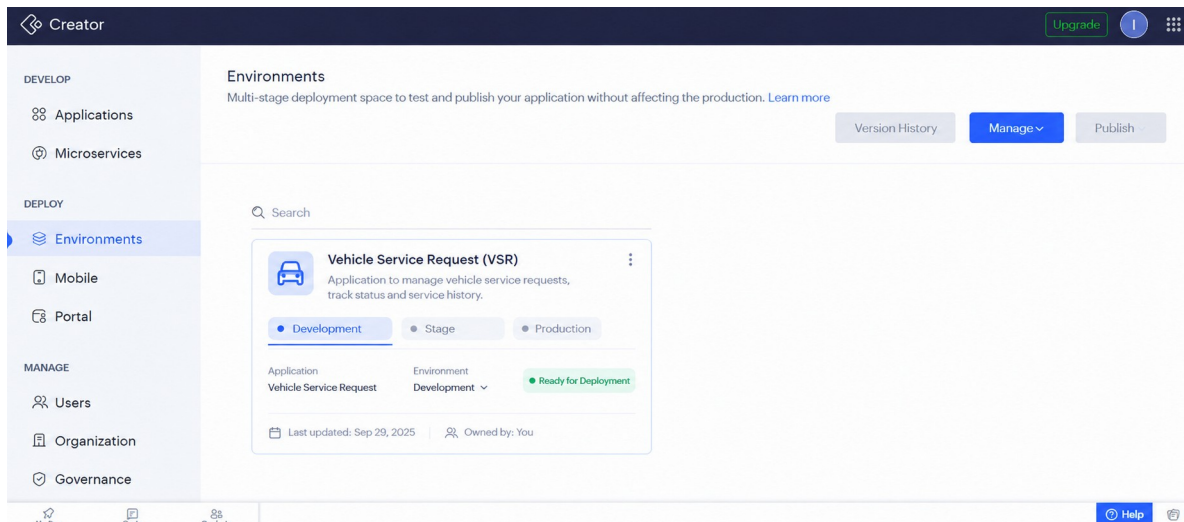


Figure 3: Development Environment Details of the Vehicle Service Request Application (Illustrative)

4. Stage environment: the application is moved from Development towards Stage. The Stage tab is selected, the Environment is Stage and the status is Testing, with the message “The application is deployed to Stage and is currently under testing.” The Deployment Progress panel shows Development as Deployed (“Application configured and ready for deployment”, Sep 29, 2025, 10:15 AM), Stage as Testing (“Application deployed to Stage and is under testing”, Sep 29, 2025, 11:42 AM) and Production as Pending (“Will be deployed after successful testing in Stage”). Deployed by: You is also shown.

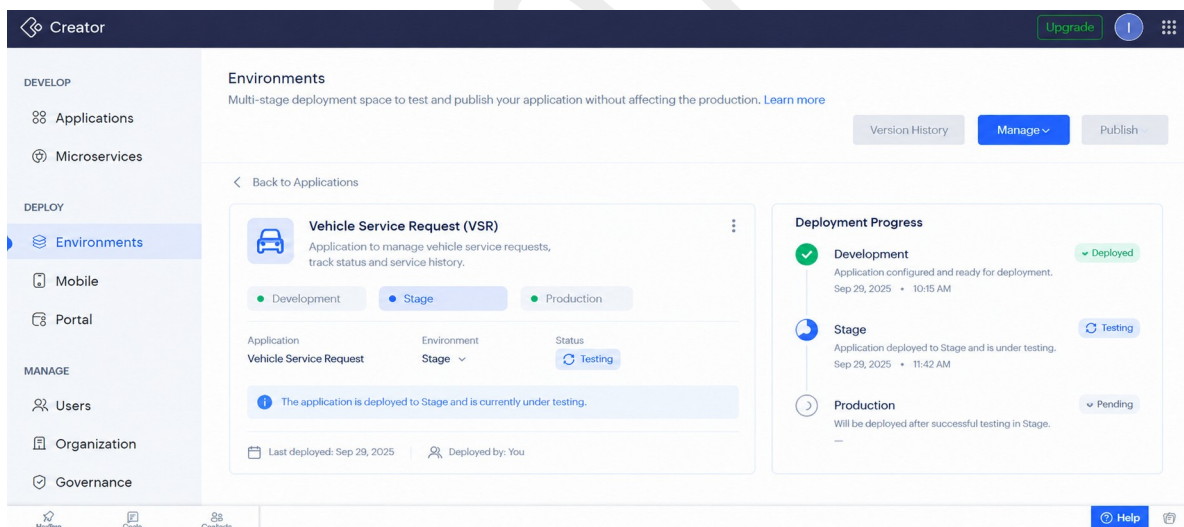


Figure 4: Stage Environment – Application Under Testing (Illustrative)

5. Production environment: after testing in Stage, the application moves to Production. The Production tab is selected, the Environment is Production and the status is Live, with the message “The application is published and live in Production.” The Deployment Progress panel shows Development as Deployed, Stage as Deployed (“Application tested and approved in Stage”, Sep 29, 2025, 11:42 AM) and Production as Live (“Application is live and accessible to end users”, Sep 30, 2025, 09:20 AM). Published by: You is also shown.

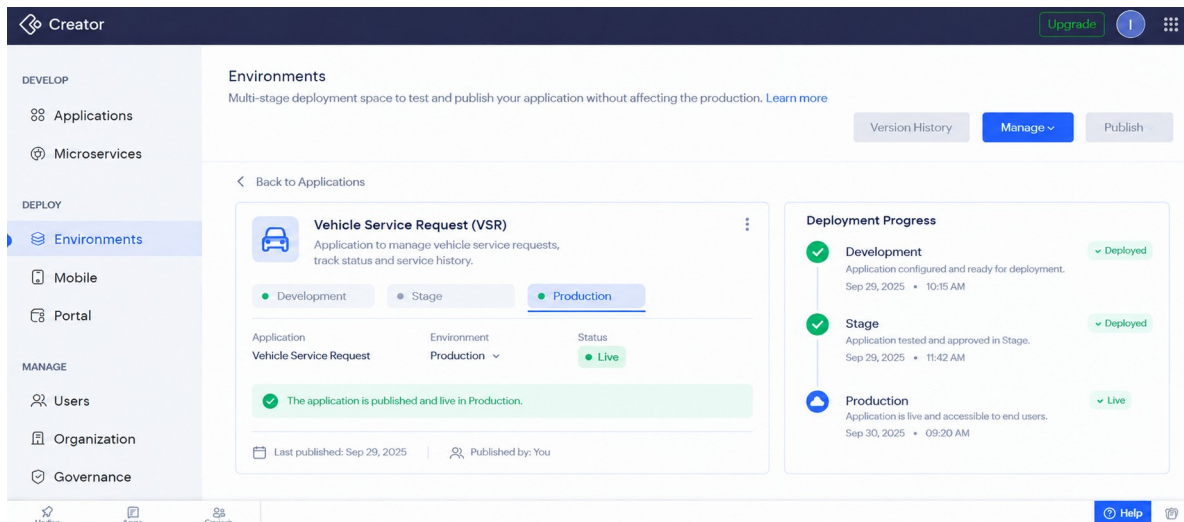


Figure 5: Production Environment – Application Live (Illustrative)

The stages and statuses shown in Figures 3 to 5 are summarised below.

Environment	Status Shown	Description Shown
Development	Ready for Deployment / Deployed	Application configured and ready for deployment.
Stage	Testing / Deployed	Application deployed to Stage and under testing; later shown as tested and approved in Stage.
Production	Pending / Live	To be deployed after successful testing in Stage; later shown as live and accessible to end users.

Conclusion

The experiment explained how a Zoho Creator application moves from development to production through environments. Changes are first made in the Development environment, the application is then deployed to Stage for testing, and only after successful testing is it published to Production, where it becomes available to end users. This staged approach keeps the live application protected from untested changes and makes releases controlled and traceable.